# Jill and the Beanstalk

## By Denise Vega

## INTRODUCTION

*Now, finally, at last - those old fairy tales have been exposed for the drivel they are! Did you ever stop to think that Sleeping Beauty might have been neutralized because she was a miserable young woman? Or that Goldilocks wore red because her mother got a great deal on a bolt of red cloth? Or perhaps, the giants in Jack and the Beanstalk weren't so bad after all . . . . compared to the poverty and neglect that plagued Jack and his mother. And come to think of it; why does it have to be Jack . . . How about Jill and the Beanstalk? by Denise Vega.*

Jill was out walking to school one morning. Her mother had given her $15 that she was supposed to give to her teacher. It was a fee for art class.

As Jill was happily skipping along, a friendly looking man stepped out of an alley, and Jill, not seeing him, skipped right into him.

"UMPHH" Was all he said at first.

Jill jumped back, dropping her money. "OH! I'm sorry," she exclaimed.

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"Quite ok," replied the man, as he picked up the money and handed it back to her. "That's quite a bit of lunch money," he said, eyeing the money.

"That's not my lunch money!" Jill giggled. "That's for art class!"

"Oh I see..." the man answered her. "Do you like art?"

Jill nodded.

"Well," said the man, "I just happen to have these....magic beans, yeah that's what they are....magic beans, and if you plant them in the ground, a huge stalk will grow up and at the top of it you will find a land filled with all kinds of art!"

Jill's eyes were wide with amazement. "Are you gonna plant them?" She asked the man.

"Well, I have no ground to put them in," the man tried to sound sad here. "Someone gave them to me for my last $15, and then I had nowhere to plant them." He looked at Jill. She appeared to be swallowing it. "If only someone who could plant them would buy them..."

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Jill looked down at her money. "Here," she said. "I wanna buy them!"

"Well, if you're sure," said the man, as he quickly snatched the money before she could change her mind. He reached into his pocket and pulled out a small leather bag with five smooth beans and gave it to her. The real origin of the beans was a small shop he had broken into downtown. There wasn't much of any value in it, or so it seemed, but he figured he could make up wild stories about the stuff and sell it to unsuspecting kids. He was a con man.

The man walked away muttering a few things quietly. "What's 'gullible' mean?" thought Jill. Shrugging her shoulders, she skipped the rest of the way to school.

When she got home, her mommy was waiting for her.

"What did you do with the money I gave you?" she asked. "Your teacher called and said you didn't give her your art fee."

Jill showed her the beans, telling her the story the man had told her. But instead of being excited about

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it, her mommy was very upset with her. She took the bag of beans and sent Jill to her room.

"Kids!" she exclaimed, slamming the bag down on the desk. As she did this, three of the beans flew out of the bag from the force, and flew right out the open window nearby.

Jill thought she heard strange sounds that night. Her bedroom just happened to be right above where the beans landed. She got up and looked out the window; just in time to see a large bean sprout go right past her window. Jill was very excited. "Mommy must have changed her mind, and planted them after all!" she thought, excited.

Jill had always been like a little monkey, climbing anything she could. Whenever she was on the playground you would find her near the Jungle Gym. Carefully she slid over the window ledge and grabbed hold of the bean sprout. Once she had a good hold, she began to climb. She climbed and climbed, and climbed some more. Jill was beginning to think she would never reach the top...it seemed as though she had been climbing for hours. In

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fact when she looked down, she couldn't even see the ground anymore.

Finally she reached what appeared to be a hole in the sky. As she climbed through it, she got off the beanstalk. It continued on up further.

Now Jill looked around her. She seemed to be on the front door of a large house. The door seemed so large to her, but she reached up and knocked on it. The door opened, and a lady looked out after a minute, peering in both directions, then down. She scared Jill...she had never seen anyone so huge! Not that the woman was fat, in fact she was very fit, but she must have been over 15 feet tall!

When the woman looked down, she exclaimed, "Why, it's a little baby! Someone left us a little baby girl!"

Forgetting her fear for just a second, Jill's hot temper caused her to be indignant. "I am not a baby!" she said, stomping her foot. "I'm nearly nine!"
The woman smiled at this childish display. "Not a baby, dear? But, then, why are you so small? I've seen two

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year olds bigger than you. And big girls don't do that..." she pointed at Jill's pants.

Jill looked down at herself. Oh No! She thought she had felt a warm sensation a moment ago! She had been so afraid when she saw the woman, that she had wet herself. Ashamed, Jill began to cry.

"Aww . . .there, there, everything will be ok" the woman consoled her, as she picked her up and carried her into the house.

They went through a kitchen and a few other rooms, up some stairs and down a hall. Jill saw a few other people in the house. They were all much bigger than she, but smaller than the woman carrying her.

"Hey, Mom, what's that?" she heard one of them call out.

The woman turned. "Not "What", Peter.... "Who". "Who is that?"

The one named Peter turned red. "Ok ok...WHO is that then?"

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"This is a baby girl someone left by our door," she said. "Look at this, she's not even properly dressed as a baby. We'll take care of that. Her name is Jill."

Jill was still sniffling as they went through a door. Inside the room was a HUGE nursery. The woman took her through the nursery and into a room of the side of it, and Jill saw it had a bathtub in it. The woman filled the tub, and sat Jill on the floor and began to take Jill's clothes off.

Since she had not slept, and had climbed so long, Jill was very tired, and she let the woman do this to her. Then the woman put her in the tub, and gently washed her.

Jill was beginning to enjoy the comforting feelings this gave her. Before she knew what was happening, her thumb had found its way to her mouth, and she was contentedly sucking.

The woman smiled at her, cooed and talked baby talk as she bathed Jill. She reached out and tickled her, and was overjoyed when Jill giggled.

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When she was finished washing her, the woman wrapped her in a towel and took her back to the nursery. Here she laid her on a changing table and dried her off. Jill realized the changing table would easily accommodate babies much bigger than herself. Then she cringed, realizing she had just thought of herself as a baby.

She was also aware of a growing need. Why hadn't there been a toilet in that bathroom?

"Umm, Ma'am?" she said softly.

The woman smiled. "Why don't you call me Mommy?" she told Jill.

"Mommy, I have to go to the bathroom."

The woman laughed lightly. "Silly baby, babies don't use potties, and even if you could, which you already proved you can't, you couldn't reach the potties here."

Jill was still not getting it. "Well then how do they..." she began, then she saw the woman was unfolding something large and white. It was a huge diaper, quite big enough for Jill. The woman easily lifted her by the

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ankles and slid the diaper under her bottom. She also took time here to apply baby powder.

Jill experienced a whole realm of new feelings as the diaper was pulled up and snugly taped into place on her. She felt shame at first, but then realized this was better than wetting her pants as she had earlier. Besides, everyone here expected her to be diapered. She felt the warm and soft coziness of the diaper, and it felt safe and secure too. She decided this was not so bad after all.

All the lost sleep was catching up to her now, and she was fading fast. The woman put a sleeper on her and carried her to a rocking chair, where she put her against her breast and began to rock her gently.

"Jill," she asked, "Those beans only work for very special people. People who are missing something. You are missing being a child, and so you must be one as long as it takes for you to get over that. Would you like to stay here and be my baby?"

Jill nodded her head. "Yes, Mommy, I would like that very much," she said, She accepted a bottle that

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was offered to her, and just as she drifted into sleep she felt a warm comfortable rush as she saturated her diapers.

## SOURCE INFORMATION

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